There was a serious moment at this meeting from which I greatly benefited. Randall, Phil Farmer, and I were interviewed by a reporter who asked us how we kept up with science. Randall and I were rather flip, but Phil very seriously described his techniques. One of them was his subcription to Scientific American.

I may be flip, but I listen. It was soon after my return that I subscribed to Scientific American myself, and I have maintained that subscription to the present day to my infinite benefit.

I wanted to leave on Sunday the twenty-third, but neither Marty nor Evelyn Gold were ready to go yet, so I drove back with Dave Kyle and two other fellows. We had a marvelous time talking McCarthy. Kyle (who had been Marty's partner when Gnome Press was started, and might still have been at this time) could imitate the McCarthy style perfectly and undertook to cross-examine me on my behavior at the Midwescon. In no time at all, he had me fruitlessly and unconvinc-ingly denying any sexual misbehavior. Although I was completely innocent of any such thing, he made me sound as guilty as Hitler.

We had started late in the day, and Kyle drove grimly through the night. I settled back beside him in the front seat to sleep, but I found myself talking steadily through the hours.

At one point, I said, "I'm sorry, Dave. I must be boring you to madness."

"No, no," said Kyle, "keeping on talking. In the first place, you're interesting, and in the second, it helps keep me awake and alert."

Then as dawn was breaking, he stopped the car and said, "Your turn, Isaac," and we switched places.

I got behind the wheel with a certain alarm. Up to that point I had never driven a car that wasn't my own, and this one was a decrepit old station wagon with, Kyle himself admitted, defective brakes. Since I had been awake all night, I peered ahead through a gray streak of road between two banks of mist and felt very woozy indeed.

"Your turn to talk and keep me awake, Dave," I said as I eased the car into the road and picked up speed. This was met with silence, and when I looked quickly to my right, I found that it was too late. Kyle was already asleep. I drove across the Pennsylvania Turnpike till breakfast time. How I kept from destroying the car and everyone in it, I don't know.